Ottawa Infotainment-Ontario Centre for Innovation

Hackathon-Based Project (Winter 2026)

Automotive Infotainment UI/UX Innovation Challenge

This project delivers a hands-on, applied innovation challenge focused on automotive infotainment systems and UI/UX, engaging over <u>100 undergraduate and graduate students</u> in real-world software development, human–computer interaction, and applied prototyping. Funded by the **Ontario Centre of Innovation (OCI)**, the initiative is designed to support experiential learning, applied research, and graduate mentorship within the School of Computer Science and **Ottawa Infotainment Inc. https://ottawainfotainment.com/**

Students work in multidisciplinary teams to address <u>four high-level</u>, thematically defined innovation challenges. These challenges are intentionally broad and brand-inspired, rather than narrowly defined technical problems, allowing flexibility for academic exploration while remaining industry-relevant. Final challenge constraints, requirements, and evaluation details will be released around mid-January.

- Around 15 to 20 students will be selected to work on a **1-2 week paid internship** after the hackathon //Selection will be made by OCI/Ottawa Infotainment
- There are chances of full-time opportunities with Ottawa Infotainment (No guarantees)

Innovation Challenge Themes

1. Retro-themed infotainment interface

A modern infotainment UI/UX concept designed for a classic vehicle retrofit, blending contemporary functionality with retro aesthetics.

2. Sporty, performance-driven infotainment interface

An infotainment UI/UX concept for a performance-oriented vehicle brand, emphasizing responsiveness, driving dynamics, and performance-focused interaction.

3. Luxury lifestyle infotainment interface

A premium infotainment UI/UX concept for a luxury vehicle brand, focusing on elegance, comfort, and lifestyle integration.

4. Rugged off-road / adventure vehicle infotainment interface

An infotainment UI/UX concept designed for off-road and adventure vehicles, emphasizing usability, durability, and interaction in challenging environments.

A competitive selection process is built into the program. While more than 100 students participate in the challenge activities, 15-20 high-performing students are selected for a one/two-week paid internship, based on technical merit, design quality, teamwork, and evaluation outcomes.